

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9

♥ 3

♦ Q 9 7 6 4 2

♣ 9 6 3

♠ K T 8

♥ A K 9 8 6 4

♦ -

♣ A K Q 7



♠ 7 4 3

♥ T 7

♦ A T 8 5

♣ J T 5 4

♠ A 6 5 2

♥ Q J 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ 8 2

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♥

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♣

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

good idea so you say 6♥.

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠A or the practically useless ♦A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠A. It looks like the slam is a

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J T 7

♦ -

♣ A 9 8 3

♠ J T 3

♥ Q 9 6

♦ K 9 8 7 5

♣ 7 6



♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J

♠ -

♥ A 5 4 3 2

♦ Q J T 4

♣ T 5 4 2

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West

North

East

South

4♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

5NT

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by East

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 5 2  
 ♥ 2  
 ♦ T 8 6 5 4  
 ♣ A 7 4 2

♠ A T 8  
 ♥ K 9 8 4  
 ♦ K 9  
 ♣ K T 6 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 9 7 4 3  
 ♥ Q J 5 3  
 ♦ 7 3 2  
 ♣ 8 3

♠ K Q J  
 ♥ A T 7 6  
 ♦ A Q J  
 ♣ Q J 9

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 2NT   |
| Pass        | 3♣    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass        | 4NT   | Pass | 5♥    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 5♥ by South |       |      |       |

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 7  
♥ K Q 9 8 5  
♦ K Q 7 4  
♣ 9 8 3

♠ T 8 6

♥ 6 4 2

♦ J T 3

♣ A 6 5 4



♠ A K Q J

♥ A J T 7

♦ A 5

♣ K Q T

♠ 9 5 4 3 2

♥ 3

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ J 7 2

With 11 points and a good suit you should make a positive response. So you bid 2♥. Partner then says 4NT. What is your bid?

The 4NT bid agrees ♥s as trump. You have one Key-Card, the ♥K, so you bid 5♣. Partner bids the ♥ slam.

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
|            |       | 2♣   | Pass  |
| 2♥         | Pass  | 4NT  | Pass  |
| 5♣         | Pass  | 6♥   |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by West |       |      |       |

**Board 5**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 4  
 ♥ Q T 2  
 ♦ 9 7 2  
 ♣ J T 9 5

♠ A Q J 7 5 3

♥ 6 5

♦ A 4 3

♣ 8 2



♠ 9 2

♥ J 7 3

♦ J T 6 5

♣ A 7 4 3

♠ K T

♥ A K 9 8 4

♦ K Q 8

♣ K Q 6

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1 ♠   | Pass | 3 ♥   |
| Pass         | 3 ♠   | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass         | 5 ♠   | Pass | 6 ♠   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6 ♠ by North |       |      |       |

The bidding has been as shown.

Your partner has shown a minimum opening hand, but with 6 ♠s. You are happy with the 8-card trump fit but need to know about Key-Cards. So you bid 4NT. Partner answers 5 ♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner has two Aces and the ♠Q. That should be all he needs to make slam so you bid 6 ♠.